

Sherwood Printers

370 Brunel Road, Mississauga ON, L4Z 2C2
905 501 1296 | info@sherwoodprinters.com

Artwork Submission Guidelines for Print-Ready Files

Dear Client,

Thank you for trusting us with your print projects. To ensure a smooth and efficient workflow — and to help us serve you faster — we kindly ask that you follow the guidelines below when submitting artwork. Our goal is to deliver your job exactly as expected, on time and without delay. Your cooperation helps us maintain best pricing and streamlined turnaround.

Checklist for Print Ready PDF Files

- ***Correct Size***

Your file must match the final trimmed size quoted, including bleed.

(Example: a 5.5 x 8.5 flyer with 0.125 bleed should be 5.75 x 8.75 total.)

- ***Include Bleed and Crop Marks***

Bleed: 0.125 (1/8") on all sides

Crop Marks: Indicate the trim area clearly

- ***Correct Page Count***

Provide files as single pages, not spreads.

Page count must match the product ordered.

- ***Correct Colour Mode***

Use CMYK for full colour jobs

Use Pantone (Spot Colour) only when quoted

Avoid RGB — colours will not print accurately

Black text and graphics should only be black (not all four colour)

- ***High Resolution***

All images must be 300 DPI at actual size.

Low-res files may appear pixelated or blurry when printed.

- ***One Job, One Email***

Include everything in one clear email:

- ***Final print-ready PDF***

Job name or PO reference

Quantity, size, paper, and finishing details (if not already quoted)

What Are Bleed and Crop Marks?

- ***Bleed***

Bleed is the extra 0.125 border around your design that allows background colours or images to extend to the edge after trimming. This prevents thin white lines from appearing along the edge of your printed piece.

- ***Crop Marks***

Crop marks are small lines in the corners of your PDF that show where we trim the final size. They help align the cut accurately and are essential for professional results.

Helpful Definitions

CMYK vs. RGB

CMYK (Cyan, Magenta, Yellow, Black): Used for professional printing

RGB (Red, Green, Blue): Used for screens; do not use for print jobs

- ***Pantone (PMS) Colours***

Special pre-mixed inks used for exact colour matching in spot colour jobs only

- ***High Resolution (300 DPI)***

Ensures sharp, professional print quality. Avoid low-resolution images (e.g. 72 DPI)

Common Issues That Cause Delays

- Files not matching quoted size & specs
- No bleed or missing crop marks
- Pages submitted as spreads instead of single pages
- Colours in RGB instead of CMYK
- Multiple emails with different versions or missing info
- Confusing or unclear job instructions

Final Tip

If you're unsure about any specs, please contact us before creating or sending your file. We're happy to help — and it avoids delays in production.

Let's work together to keep every job smooth, accurate, and professional.

Warm regards,

Manoj Sheth
Sherwood Printers